

China's Submarine Missile Test Rattles the Pacific as Air Defense Gaps Exposed in Kyiv

China conducted its first submarine-launched ballistic missile test in the Pacific, India approved \$6.2B in defense acquisitions, and Ukraine's Patriot shortage let Russian ballistic missiles strike Kyiv unimpeded — underscoring the global race between offensive capabilities and air defense capacity.

The Bottom Line

China's first submarine-launched ballistic missile test in the Pacific, India and Pakistan's simultaneous multi-billion-dollar arms buildups, and Ukraine's inability to stop Russian ballistic missiles over Kyiv all point to the same structural shift: the gap between offensive strike capability and defensive capacity is widening globally. The GCAP fighter program's \$6.1B investment after FCAS collapsed, AeroVironment's \$500M domestic counter-drone contract, and the Australia-Fiji defense pact signed on the same day as China's missile test each reflect different facets of the same reality — states are racing to build and deploy faster than they can defend.